Kristopher Nichols

Ph.D Student in Psychology, Princeton University

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Education

Princeton University — *Princeton, New Jersey*

Ph.D., Psychology. Doctoral Advisor: Elke U. Weber — *2028 (Expected)*

Kahneman-Treisman Center — *Princeton University*

Student Affiliate — *2024-*

University of Chicago — *Chicago, Illinois*

M.A., Social Sciences — *2018*

University of Chicago — *Chicago, Illinois*

Certificate in Computational Social Science — *2018*

Stephen F. Austin State University — *Nacogdoches, Texas*

B.A., Psychology (with Honors; University Scholar) — *2017*

Honors & Awards

Beijer Institute of Ecological Economics Young Scholar — *2027*

Graduate Fellow in Cognitive Science — *2026*

Sigma Xi Member — *2026*

Besample Dissertation Grant — *2026*

Hamid Biglari *87 Behavioral Science Fellow, Kahneman-Treisman Center for Behavioral Science & Public Policy, Princeton University — *2025*

Co-Organizer and Princeton University Representative, Six College Conference — *2025*

National Academy of Sciences Complexity Research Grant — *2024*

Summer School for Systems Modeling, International Institute for Applied Systems Analysis (IIASA) — *2024*

Small Scale Research Grant ($5,000), Center for Data Driven Social Science, Princeton University — *2024*

Best Poster Award, Andlinger Center for Energy and the Environment, Princeton University — *2023*

President's Fellowship, Princeton University — *2023*

SFASU University Scholar — *2017*

Psi Chi Research Travel Grant - SPSP — *2017*

SFASU College of Liberal and Applied Arts Psychology Research Award — *2016*

SFASU Psychology Department Outstanding Undergraduate Researcher Award — *2016*

Scholarly Publications

Nichols, K. L., Matt-Navarro, J. M., Doiron, M. K., D'Adda, G., Weber, E. U. & Constantino, S. M. (2026). Do risk, time, and social preferences predict sustainable behavior? Evidence from a qualitative synthesis and meta-analysis. Ecological Economics. https://doi.org/10.1016/j.ecolecon.2025.108804 — *2026*

De Weerdt, L., **Nichols, K. L.** & Weber, E. U. (2026). Can wind energy help West Virginia off its coal-mining addiction? Energy Research & Social Science. https://doi.org/10.1016/j.erss.2025.104478 — *2026*

Mastroianni, A., **Nichols, K. L.** & Dana, J. Both Democrats and Republicans can pass the Ideological Turing Test. Experimental History. https://www.experimental-history.com/p/ideological-turing-test *2024*

Working Papers

Nichols, K.L.[*], Composto, J.W.[*], Weber, E.U. How norm information on cable news shapes perceptions about democracy. **Revise and Resubmit - Proceedings of the National Academy of Sciences; Preprint available here.**

Nichols, K.L., Yang, F., Goldwert, D., Composto, J.W., Weber, E.U., Sparkman, G. A Meta-Analysis of Social Norm Processes.

Nichols, K.L., Salim, A., Weber, E.U., Hurricane Attribution to Climate Change: Sources of Accuracy and Errors

Finke, K., **Nichols, K.L.**, Weber, E.U., Tarnita, C. A complex systems framework reveals hidden context-dependence of behavior transitions. **Under Review; Preprint available here.**

Invited Talks

Social Area Seminar, Department of Psychology, Boston College *July 2025*

Selected Presentations

Nichols, K.L., Composto J.W., Weber, E.U., How norm information on cable news shapes perceptions about democracy. Symposium presentation at Solidarity Symposia: Keeping Democracy Strong, Kings College London. **(Best Talk Award)** *2026*

Nichols, K.L., Salim, A., Weber, E.U., Hurricane Attribution to Climate Change: Sources of Accuracy and Errors. Symposium presentation at Society for Personality and Social Psychology (SPSP). *2026*

Finke, K., **Nichols, K.L.**, Weber, E.U., Tarnita, C. Beyond One-size-fits-all: A complex systems framework reveals hidden context-dependence of behavior transitions. presentation at Cultural Evolution Society Conference *2026*

Nichols, K.L., Salim, A., Weber, E.U., Hurricane Attribution to Climate Change: Sources of Accuracy and Errors. Poster presentation at the International Conference on Environmental Psychology. *2025*

Nichols, K.L., Composto, J., Weber, E.U., Social Norms in Media: How the Prominence of Social Norms in Cable Television Shapes Norm Perceptions and Attitudes about Democracy. Data Blitz presentation at the Six College Conference. *2025*

Nichols, K.L., Composto, J., Weber, E.U., Social Norms in Media: How the Prominence of Social Norms in Cable Television Shapes Norm Perceptions and Attitudes about Democracy. Poster presentation at the Society for Personality and Social Psychology (SPSP). *2025*

Composto, J., **Nichols, K.L.**, Weber, E.U., Social Norms in Media: How the Prominence of Social Norms in Cable Television Shapes Norm Perceptions and Attitudes about Democracy. Poster presentation at the Norms and Behavioral Change Conference (NoBeC). *2024*

De Weerdt, L., **Nichols, K. L.**, Weber, E. U. Can wind energy help West Virginia off its coal-mining addiction? Poster presentation at the Andlinger Center for Energy and the Environment Annual Meeting. **(Best Poster Award)**. *2023*

Skills

Data science and Coding Expertise

Extensive experience with data management, machine learning, experimental programming, visualization, and statistical modeling in R and Python.

Large Language Models

Fine-tuning transformer models (Gemma, BERT) for text classification. Experience with FSDP distributed training for 27B+ parameter models.

High-Performance Computing

Experience with Princeton's Della cluster for distributed ML training, SLURM job scheduling, and GPU optimization.